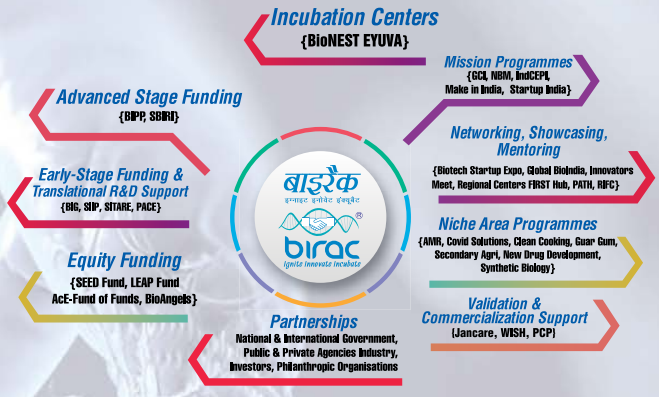
Empowering India's Biotech Revolution for a Sustainable Future

India's ambition to become the world's third-largest economy by 2025 is rooted in its commitment to innovation, with biotechnology at the forefront. The sector, valued at USD 151 Billion in 2023, contributes 4.25% to the national GDP. A key player in this transformation is the Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC), a not-for-profit enterprise under the Department of Biotechnology. Since its establishment in 2012, BIRAC has catalyzed India's biotech ecosystem by empowering entrepreneurs, driving research, and enabling the commercialization of innovative solutions.

Fostering Innovation and Strengthening Biomanufacturing capacity

BIRAC has been a pivotal force for India's Biotechnology sector, driving innovation and fostering a globally competitive ecosystem over the past 12 years. BIRAC has provided comprehensive support to startups, SMEs, and large companies through schemes and initiatives including funding as grants and equity, Incubation support, Product commercialization, guidance for intellectual property, regulatory processes, mentoring, showcasing and networking. BIRAC collaborates with prominent national and international partners to effectively implement its programmes and initiatives. BIRAC houses Project Management Units and implements large mission programmes including the National Biopharma Mission (NBM), in collaboration with the World Bank; the Grand Challenges India (GCI) in collaboration with the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation (BMGF) and the National Make-in-India Mission for Biotech.



Some of the notable innovations developed through BIRAC support include indigenous vaccines against Covid, HPV; affordable, Made-in-India, 1.5 Tesla MRI scanner; a novel antibiotic against drug-resistant bacterial pathogens and so on. Such achievements underscore BIRAC's critical role in advancing biotechnology, strengthening healthcare, and supporting India's journey toward self-reliance in cutting-edge technologies. These achievements not only strengthen healthcare and advance biotechnology but also contribute to India's growing prominence as a global leader in biomanufacturing, now ranked third in the Asia-Pacific region and 12th globally. Bio-E3 (Biotechnology for Economy, Environment, and Employment) policy recently approved by the Cabinet and championed by the Department of Biotechnology is strengthening this foundation further. The policy envisages setting up of biofoundries and bio-enabler hubs in different thematic sectors that will contribute significantly to paving way for a future driven by sustainable innovations and position India as a key player in the global bioeconomy.



Vaccines developed under Mission Covid Suraksha led by DBT and implemented by BIRAC

BIRAC is committed to shaping the future of India's biotech sector while ensuring that India emerges as a global powerhouse in biotechnology. BIRAC constantly strives to understand bio-enterprises' current and future needs and bring transformative changes by supporting and sustaining cutting-edge technologies. It also has a larger vision of being a global manufacturing hub to reach the mission of becoming "Viksit Bharat" by 2047.

12+ YEARS OF BIRAC:
Nurturing & Strengthening Biotech Innovation Enterprises

Incubation Centres	95	Startups/other beneficiaries supported	4800+	BIRAC Funding	4000 Cr+
Students/ entrepreneurs engaged	15 Lakh+	Mentor Pool	10,000+	Follow-on-funding raised by > 130 Startups	5500 Cr+
Academia Supported	400+	Products in market	800+	Co-funding by Industry & Others	2600 Cr+